

not shown. If hackers log in and want to copy files, they cannot find where the directory of the database is located," Guharoy claims.

Smooth handling of large data

Guharoy also considers PostgreSQL a good choice for handling the large volumes of data at the media house. The average views per day for its websites range between 500 and 700, and on peak days, this figure is in the thousands. Handling this traffic is made easier as the organisation uses a cache server. "When there are repeated requests for some news stories, that data gets stored on the cache server. As a result, when viewers request the same news, there is no direct connection to the database, yet their requests are answered by the cache," says Guharoy.

Data backup made easy

PostgreSQL also makes it simple to take a data backup, for those 'just in case' scenarios. Guharoy adds that she learnt about these features by reading articles and participating in online forums. She explains, "Usually, if the size of the database is large, we face a lot of difficulty in restoring data if it crashes. However, you can easily back up your data on PostgreSQL with some simple commands. You can dump the database, and if you have problems with your database,

you can restore all data from the dump. It will reconstruct the database to the state it was in at the time of the dump. If it was stored in a previous version of PostgreSQL, the data can still be converted by giving the appropriate command."

Simultaneous processes

PostgreSQL has proven to be a good solution when multiple paths of execution are running at the same time. "We can run simultaneous processes like PostgreSQL, Apache and basic Linux environment applications at the same time. It also ensures a high performance on large workloads, with lots of concurrency. Our Apache connection has 2,000 Web connections, and the database on PostgreSQL has 300 connections simultaneously," she adds.

The media house intends to upgrade its servers in the near future, as it has been noticing an increase in traffic to the websites. "There has been a continuous growth in the number of website visitors, and we intend to upgrade our servers to match the growth of our websites," Guharoy concludes. 

By: Jalaja Ramanunni

The author is a business correspondent at the EFY Group. She is a fan of anything portable, and loves exploring different genres of music and movies.



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